

SUMI'S JOURNEY

Game Design Document | Assignment 2

Game Title – Sumi's Journey

Backstory

Sumi is an adventurous cat who spots a commercial for Moon Flakes that are “Only Available in The City”. Without hesitation, Sumi gets too excited and runs out, leaving the gate open and heads for the city in search of the Moon Flakes. Sumi travels through the mountains, a mysterious swamp, and finally The City. Along the way, clues surface about what the treat is really made of. Players help Sumi collect hidden ingredient pieces scattered throughout the journey. Whether or not all pieces are collected will determine if Sumi learns the truth about Moon Flakes before it's too late.

Sumi's Journey is a story about curiosity, the comfort of home, and the lesson that not everything that seems good is always worth it and that sometimes the best things were never far.

Characters

- Main Character – Sumi
 - A curious, nimble cat that usually carries a small backpack, depending on the playthrough (it is a narrative element that ties into the Good Ending). Sumi moves around with arrow keys, left, right and up (jump) arrow keys. Interact with NPCs with ellipses using **M**. When the player gets hurt by enemies, it will play a hiss sound and cause the player to be knocked back.
- Enemies

Enemies	Level	Behaviour	Effect
Swooping Birds	1	When player is within the bird zones, total of 2 zones, three birds will spawn from the right side of the scene and go straight at a specified world y position. Plays a chirp sound when the bird spawns. Player has to either jump over the birds or just wait and avoid them.	Lose 1 life on contact and knocking back the player.
Rain Frogs	2	Frogs will jump up and down on a lily pad. The croaking of frogs can be heard when player gets close enough, in 'Croak Zones'. When the frog jumps it croaks as a signal and the rhythm of jumping is consistent. Player has to time and jump over the frogs or in some cases even step on the lily pad (which does not fall by design).	Lose 1 life on contact and knocking back the player.
Security Drones	3	Drones that move horizontally and have a beam of light that spots the player if they came into contact. To avoid the drone there will be boxes to hide behind in which case the Drone cannot spot the player.	Lose 1 life on contact and knocking back the player.

- NPCs
 - At each level there will be two NPCs. Players can ONLY interact with NPCs that have an ellipses. Upon Interacting with the last NPC/Moon Flake the three levels, it will trigger a transition to the next level.

NPC	Level	Speech – Default	Speech - Secret
Raven	1	Up ahead there should be a frog in a rain coat, make it up the platform and you shall find your way.	I heard these birds love to steal things...they usually hide them in their nest and they're sensitive to sounds.
Frog – Rain	1	I heard you're after the moon flakes. Find my brother, he resides in the swamp regions, and he has what you need.	N/A. Checkpoint character.
Willow O'Wisp	2	Past the frog that sleeps, you'll find a drone. It will guide you past the city gates.	The bog reveals its secrets to those who do not run from the shaking ground. Look carefully at what lies ahead, not every lily is the same
Drone Next to City House	2	After the Moon Flakes huh?...I'll help you pass the city gates.	N/A. Checkpoint character.
Holo Drone – Holding advertisement screen	3	Past the sound of dripping water you will find what you seek.	Something in this area has been slowly winning against the drones. Drip by drip.
Moon Flakes	3	N/A. Upon interaction player moves to one of the endings.	N/A. Checkpoint Object.

Gameplay

- Gameplay Mechanics
 - **Controls:**
 - Arrow keys to move left, right and up to jump.
 - M to meow and interact with NPCs with ellipses. Ellipses show they have something to say.
 - **Lives:**
 - Each level grants three lives for a total of 9 lives. Like the saying a cat has 9 lives.
 - Player will lose one life on contact with hostiles which include, Birds, Frogs, Drones.
 - **Puzzles**

Recipe Piece	Level	Solving the Puzzle	Sound Cues
Piece 1	1	Near the end of the level there are platforms the player has to jump up to get to the end. On the last jump, player can jump down where there is a bird in a nest. To get the bird to move player has to press M and meow when it's close enough to the bird. It will then reveal the piece and the player jumps back to the left platforms and continues the regular route.	Upon player interacting with the bird, a bird sound is heard as it flies away. Once the player collects it, a collection sound will be played to notify the player it has collected it.
Piece 2	2	After talking with the willow there is a series of lily pads, player jumps until it reaches the last lily pad before the sleeping frog and just stays on the lily pad. It will trigger the sleeping frog brother to move and reveal the secret behind it. The lily pad is also slightly larger than all the other lily pads.	Upon the player standing long enough on the special lily, it will trigger a cartoon jump sound as the brother jumps off the stump.

Piece 3	3	When player gets close enough to the puzzle, player will hear a water dripping sound and they will see water dripping into a jug. Player has to push the jug off the edge. It will collide with the drone below and reveal the last secret inside the wall below.	When the jug gets dropped on the drone, it will play a electric short-circuiting sound and show a broken drone texture while it falls to the floor.
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- **Checkpoints:**

- At the end of each level there will be one NPC where the player will interact with by using M, and it will save the game states, whether the player has collected the recipe, and transition to the next level. In level 3 the 'NPC' is the Moon Flakes. Upon interaction it will play the Good Ending or Bad Ending depending if player collected all three recipe pieces.

- **Feedback System:**

- Before each enemy/obstacle, there will be text to notify the player in advance.

Level	Obstacle / Enemy	Text to Warn Player Before Hand
1	Birds	Keep an eye out for birds — dodge them or let them fly by
2	Lily pads	Tread lightly — lily pads crumble beneath you
2	Frogs	Watch the frogs' rhythm before you leap
3	Moving Platforms	Careful! Moving platforms ahead.
3	Drones	Drones patrol this sector. Stay behind cover or be detected.

- **Game Flow**

- Launch screen -> Start Button -> Beginning Cut Scene 1
- Level 1 – Chapter 1: Beyond the Peaks -> Birds as enemies will chirp when spawned, raven npc, ingredient behind trigger puzzle. Frog in rain coat transitions the player to level 2 and saves game states.
- Level 2 – Chapter 2: The Quiet Bog -> disappearing lily pad platforms, rain frog enemies jumping up and down, NPC drone which will trigger the next level, Level3
- Level 3 – Chapter 3: Shadows and Concrete -> moving platforms, horizontal patrolling drones, secret is behind a wall. Player has to break the drone guarding that area.

- **Rules & Victory Conditions**

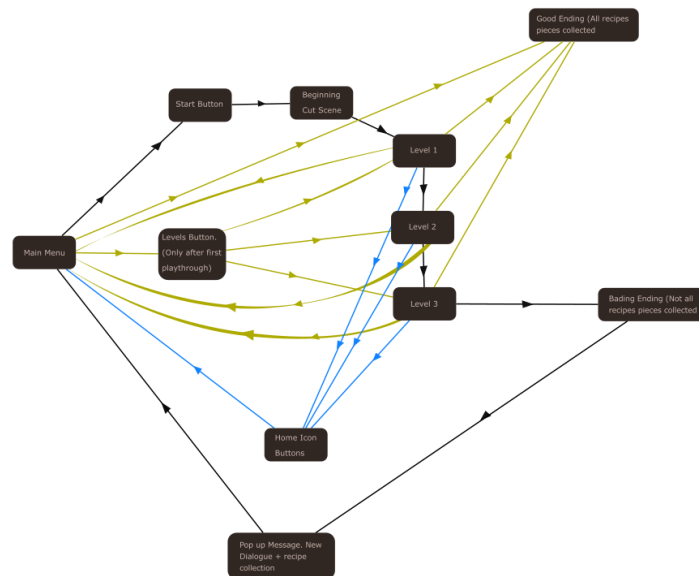
- The goal for the first playthrough is to get to the end of all three levels to complete the first run.
- The goal in the subsequent is to solve the puzzles in each level and collect the recipe pieces.
- Collecting only either 1 or 2 pieces will not trigger the Good Ending, it only triggers the Good Ending once the player solves all three puzzles and collects all three pieces of the recipe.
- Loosing all three lives in each level will trigger a Game Over Scene in which the player can choose to restart the level. If player falls it will also trigger a Game Over Scene and player restarts level.
- **Endings**
 - **Standard Ending:** Player doesn't collect all three recipe pieces. Sumi eats the Moon Flakes, unaware of it's contents, gets sick and loses its energy and cannot return home meanwhile the owner has already prepared the food for Sumi and is looking for Sumi.
 - **Good/True Ending:** Player finds all recipe pieces. Sumi meets a fellow cat and explains to them that's what's in the Moon Flakes. Sumi reconsiders and reminisces home cooked food. Then Sumi recalls that the owner had put a backpack and snacks in it. Shown in the second start scene with Sumi's owner saying "Sumi your backpack and snacks are ready". Sumi would shake and the snacks would fall out to which Sumi will take one and start the adventure back home.

Game World

- Sumi's Journey is a side scrolling platformer across three environments that shows a visual and emotional journey.

Level	Description	Environment
1	A warm and excited vibe as the player begins their adventure, accompanied by a upbeat and bright soundtrack, evoking the feeling of setting out on an adventure on a scrip morning. Terrain challenge, mastering jumping from platform to platform.	
2	A murky and treacherous, slightly unsettling vibe as the player ventures further away from home. The soundtrack shifts to a mellow lofi soundtrack, slower and more atmospheric. It reflects the murky, quieter nature of the swamp. Terrain challenge, mastering timing as lily pads fall underneath player upon contact after a couple seconds.	
3	The big city, a dark and unfamiliar territory anything unlike home. The soundtrack becomes more tense and futuristic, with a darker feel that mirrors the cold and unfamiliarity of the city. Terrain challenge, moving platforms and player has to time it properly and jump at the right moment.	

World Navigation Flowchart



- Player moves linearly through the first play through. Start, beginning cut scene and then level 1, level 2, and level 3. Where the player gets the bad ending and that brings them back to the main menu but with a popup. Pop up leads back to main menu. Now main menu has a levels button. Player can choose a level to attempt at getting the secret recipe with new dialogue for some of the NPCs. After each successful play in level selection, it will return to main menu. Once the player collects the last remaining piece needed for the True Ending, the player will trigger the good ending at the end of the level when they talk with the NPC.

Bonus Materials

- **New Game + (Unlocked after first playthrough)**
 - Once the player gets the Bad Ending, the main menu screen changes, showing the gate has been open; Sumi has left home. Upon getting the Good Ending, it will show Sumi walking into the gate and the owner calling for Sumi.
 - After the first playthrough, the middle npc (raven, willow, holo drone) has new dialogue (explained in the popup after the player comes back from bad ending), hinting at how to find the recipe pieces.
 - The True Ending can still be obtain in the first play through, it rewards curious and experimental players.
- **Replay Incentives:**
 - Standard Ending includes an explicit replay hook encouraging a second playthrough to try and find the secret in every level to unlock the true ending.
 - In subsequent playthrough after the first, there is new dialogue that hints at where the secret could be but not telling the player on how to actually solve it.
 - Ingredient-pieces collection shows as visible HUD upon succession of the first playthrough, motivating completionists exploration.
 - In level selection, it will show a gold star for levels where the player has collected the secret recipe piece.
 - The bad ending should leave the player feeling unsatisfied with the ending. Having gone through that adventure just to not be able to return home. Giving a better alternative if the player collects all the secret pieces.

SUMI'S JOURNEY

Game Design Document | Assignment 3

Continuation • Morph Mechanics • Three New Levels

Game Title

Sumi's Journey + DLC

Overview

Sumi's Journey. Assignment 3 continues directly after the Standard (bad) Ending of Assignment 2. Sumi ate the Moon Flakes without knowing their contents, falls ill, and is now trapped inside the Moon Flakes research facility, Lumico.

The DLC introduces the Morph System: an involuntary mutation caused by the Moon Flakes gives Sumi the ability to transform between three forms. Cat, Dog, and Human, each with distinct abilities. Players must use all three forms, a single-slot inventory, and multi-step environmental puzzles across three new levels to help Sumi find an antidote, sabotage the corporation, and escape home.

The overarching theme mirrors A2's message: the city is not what it seems, and the truth is uncovered only by those who look carefully and find the secrets hidden within.

Rather than extending A2's existing levels, the goal with A3 is to branch off from the original story rather than dragging out the story in A2. A3 is the DLC to A2. It introduces entirely new mechanics (morphing), new controls (F, E) a new narrative chapter, and new game systems and all new multi-step puzzles. It is structured as a DLC continuation rather than a level expansion to reflect the scope of the additions and play into the narrative of A2's original standard ending.

Both the DLC and the original game is a browser based HTML5 game and was tested on Opera, but can run on chrome, Firefox.

Backstory Continuation

After eating the Moon Flakes, Sumi collapses near the corporation who made the Moon Flakes, Lumico. A few workers realized that this cat seemed to react differently and took Sumi into the laboratory.

Shortly after waking, Sumi realizes that they're in a cage. Only through escaping the cage does Sumi realize that something has happened to them. A fright caused an involuntary transformation triggered by the serum in the Moon Flakes. Sumi has become a dog. Panicked, Sumi discovers that pressing a key (1, 2) can cycle through new forms the serum has unlocked. The mutation is unstable, but it might be the only way out.

Sumi's goals across the three new levels:

- **Level 4 Escape Protocol:** Escape the Lumico testing section of the lab. Introduction to dog form and uses both dog and cat forms to escape.
- **Level 5 Lumico:** Get through corporate HQ and introduction to third morph (human) form and using all forms to get through the level and get through the loading dock.
- **Level 6 The Shipment:** Sabotage the Lumico cargo shipment while on board and escape home. Uses all three forms.

Characters / Items

Sumi returns as the protagonist, now carrying the effects of the Moon Flakes serum. The backpack from the Good Ending of A2 is absent. This is the continuation of the Bad Ending path, the DLC to the original. Sumi can now morph between three forms using number keys. The morph is accompanied by a short transformation animation.

Form	Key(Numbers at the top of keyboard)	Abilities	Limitations	Unlock
Cat	1	High jump, squeeze through vents	Cannot move heavy objects, cannot use tools, not socially recognised	Introduced in A2: default form
Dog	2	Sniff hidden vents and carry items cat can't.	Cannot use human tools and can only carry certain objects. Cannot fit through vents	Involuntary intro in Level 4 (jump-scare cutscene)
Human	3	Use tools (pc, wrench, printer), carry keycard, move heavy objects, wear chef hat to bypass humans.	Lowest jump height, cannot fit through vents	Intro in Level 5 via showcase discovery

Switching forms drops any held items on the spot. Players must plan their form use carefully around the single-slot inventory.

NPCs	Level	Role / Key Dialogue
Jump Scare Blob	4	Forces the player to morph into Dog form to showcase that morphing is a mechanism in the game.
Guard	4	Guards the exit to Level 4. Can be manipulated to leave post after player triggers the right sequence.

Receptionist	5	Receptionist hints at needing to scan before going through into Lumico.
Employee	5	Positioned in the office section of the level. Tells player that everyone keeps their ID on their persons, and to not bother Kenji. Hints at Kenji misplacing things when panicked.
Kenji	5	Panicking over a print job. Can be manipulated into dropping his ID card and a wrench.
Dr. Krieg	5	Hints that tank B is cracked and a strong enough impact will break it.
Chef	6	Guards kitchen access. Lets human form through with chef hat
Guards + Guards with Dogs	6	Hints towards uniform in lockers and provides environmental flavour and minor hints
Captain	6	Woken by the bell; key role is to unlock the bunker section for the player.

Item	Level	Weight	Forms That Can Use it	Purpose
Clippers	4	Light	All forms	Used to cut the wire in level 4 when the player first breaks out of the cage. It opens the door to the right.
Electrical Panel	4	Interactive	All forms	Plays use the clippers on this panel to open the door
Key card	4	Light	All forms	Used to be scanned on the terminal in the right of the second section after the first room.
Terminal	4	Interactive	All forms	Use with key card in inventory to open door
Garbage	4	Medium	Dog and Human	Player has to dispose of garbage to trigger a cutscene and reveal key puzzle pieces to the level
Disposer	4	Interactive	All forms	Place to dispose the garbage to trigger the cutscene
Sticky note 1 + Sticky note 2	4	Interactive	All forms	Hints towards the sequence puzzle and where the sequence is.
Vent covers 1 + 2	4	Interactive	Dog form	Player must be in dog form to find and open vents
Sequence buttons	4	Interactive	All forms	Player has to enter the correct sequence to get the guard to move and another secret sequence to obtain antidote

Fingerprint Scanner	5	Interactive	All forms. Key to human form.	Only human form can use the terminal to open the door
Dual ID Terminal	5	Interactive	Human form	Player has to find two access cards to interact with it
Tanks	5	Interactive	Human form	Player will use a wrench to break the tank which will reveal the first access card
Mouse	5	Light	Cat form	Only cat form can obtain mouse in vents. Used to obtain the first antidote
PC	5	Interactive	Human form	Player sends email to trigger interactions with NPCs
Printer	5	Interactive	Human form	Player jams printer with paper to trigger cutscene
Paper	5	Light	All forms	Crumpled paper used on printer
Lockers 1 – 8	6	Interactive	All forms	Players can open lockers. Locker 5 is the special locker.
Chef Hat	6	Light	All forms	All forms can pick up hat. Only human form can 'wear' it
Bed 3	6	Interactive	Dog	Player can interact with all other beds but bed 3 holds the key card. Player has to be in dog form to find it.
Access key	6	Interactive	All forms	Used to unlock the control room door
Bookshelf	6	Interactive	Human	Only human form can move the bookshelf to reveal a safe
Safe	6	Interactive	Human	Solving the safe puzzle will reveal the another antidote
Control panel	6	Interactive	All forms	Triggers the last scene, the crane minigame

Gameplay

- **Arrow Keys** – Move left, right; Up to jump. Jump height varies by form (Cat highest, Human lowest).
- **1 / 2 / 3** – Switch to Cat / Dog / Human form respectively. Held item is dropped on switch.
- **M** – Meow / Interact with NPCs (Only in levels 1-3). In levels 4-6, purely for extra content.
- **F** – Pickup or drop an item in the world. Each item has a weight. Some items cannot be carried by dog or cat, only human form.
- **E** – Interact with items/objects in the world. This will display player dialogue and a text box.

Morphing Logic System

The morph system is the core new mechanic of A3. Key design rules:

- Level 4 introduces the use of both cat and dog forms together to solve puzzles. Human unlocks in Level 5 in which the player can use all three forms to solve puzzles.
- Each form has a distinct silhouette and morph animation to give the player instant visual feedback on their current form.
- Morphing is instant but plays an animation and movement is disabled until the animation is complete, but switching drops inventory, cannot morph while in mid air. This creates meaningful trade-off decisions throughout each level.

Each form **provides branching narrative content** that rewards players who replay as different forms or favor a specific form. Each form is given a specific/unique personality, and it shows through their interactions with each NPC and items.

Inventory

- Sumi can hold one item at a time. Items are picked up with F and displayed as a small icon in the bottom right HUD with the name of the item displayed as well.
- Switching forms drops the current item at Sumi's feet. If player is currently in front of any interactive items, it will tell the player the item cannot be dropped here.
- If the player switches forms (immediately dropping an item/force dropping an item) in front of any interactive items, the item will be placed safely somewhere nearby out of the range any interactive items.
- Items can be used to interact with specific objects in the environment while in inventory. A wire cutter to cut the wires, a keycard unlocks doors.
- Some items can only be picked up by the Human form (heavy or tool-based).
- The inventory slot is visible in the bottom right HUD corner, and the item name is displayed above the inventory slot. Empty slot and no text is shown when nothing is held.

Lives

A3 removes the lives system from A2. On contact with certain enemies player will be knocked back and movement is disabled temporarily. This reflects the shift from A2's light hearted adventure to A3's reality, having to find ways to escape. Stakes feel higher with there is no hand holding and not just left and right movement. It also ties in with the art style for A3, much darker and serious compared to A2.

- There are no lives system.
- **On contact with enemies player** is knocked back. Shows dialogue from npcs/enemies.
- **Game Over:** There is no game over state in the DLC due to the complexity and the time it takes to solve puzzles to prevent players from feeling frustrated.

Hint System

To further the experience of the game without hand holding to match the serious and darker theme, a hint button is provided to players who may become stuck and just need a little nudge without feeling

frustrated or taking away the decision to figure it out on their own. The goal of the hint system is to **address the issue of discoverability risks**. Hence if players cannot solve the puzzles or understand, the hints will guide or tell players how to solve all the puzzles and proceed with the game without further frustration.

- In the first DLC play through, for each level there are a total of 5 hints.
- Each hint progress how much to reveal.
- The last hint will spell out what the puzzles are if the puzzles become too complex or is not obvious.
- On subsequent play throughs, hints will be guiding the players to toward secret puzzles or locations where the antidotes may be.
- The intention of the hint system it to remove discoverability risks without breaking immersion.

Feedback System

Rather than text warnings (shown in A2), A3 uses environmental and audio feedback. Visual and audio cues are embedded into the world at each level. Any and all interactive items that aren't pickupable will display a dialogue about the interactive item. Each form will have different things to say about every item. Some forms provide more information than others depending on the interactive item.

Obstacle / Feature	Level	Feedback Method
Pickup able items and interactives	4, 5, 6	All items including pickup able items and interactive items will be highlighted to indicate which item is currently being interacted/pickup. Inventory slot also displays the sprite and text of what the item is. Glow is cleared when player is out of range. A little E or F is also shown on top of the item to tell remind the player which items are interactives (E) and which items can be picked up (F).
Cage Swing Intro	4	Player is visually inside a cage and is swaying slightly back and forth. Left and right is the only option, and a metal squeaking sound is heard as the player continues to swing. Cage hits the wall with a loud bang to which the camera would also shake and flash white briefly to simulate a collision.
Wire & Clippers	4	A yellow wire can be visibly seen connected to the door. Clippers set on the floor in plain sight.
Vents	4, 5	In level 4 the vents can only be opened in dog form and crawled through in cat form. In level 5 the vent can be discovered in cat form. But in both levels the vent is highlighted and sound cues can be heard. Level 4 is a vent opening sound. Level 5 is the mouse squeak sound.
Garbage puzzle	4	Upon interacting with the disposer and the garbage player inventory, a metal door closing sound is heard to tell the player they are disposing and dumping something in. On the wall also it says "DISPOSAL" and talks about last disposal dates to hint at what needs to be done in that room The guard cutscene also hints at stench.
Doors	4, 5, 6	All doors will play a sound while opening and a tween to show the fading of the door sprite.

Kenji/Printer puzzle	5	Printer will beep and kenji is shown to be getting up and walking towards the printer. Beeping stops when kenji reaches the printer.
PC	5	PC mouse sounds and interface sounds are played when interacting with it. Wrong file will trigger a sound and show error message. Correct file sent will show a cutscene and unlocks a door.
Tanks	5	Upon breaking the tank with a wrench, a loud smash sound is heard and an animation plays showing water leaking out and pooling. Scientist npc is shown to hurriedly come over and shows dialogue as well.
Chef	6	Player is seen to physically be pushed back when they come into contact without the correct form and item.
Crane Controls	6	Plays sound every time the crane is moving, buttons also all labeled
Safe puzzle	6	All button presses play a sound and the safe displays what the player types in and how many letters/numbers are needed. Plays correct sound upon correct code showing the antidote after. Plays wrong sound upon incorrect code.

Game Flow

After completing levels 1-3 for the first time, the main menu gains two new buttons: A levels button (same as A2) and a DLC button. The DLC button leads to the DLC Start Scene. A short panel explain the timeline and events leading up to level 4. The 'next' button starts Level 4.

Step	Description
DLC Start Scene	Cutscene recap of the Bad Ending: Sumi collapses, Lumico workers carry Sumi into the lab for further experiments/analysis.
Level 4 – Escape Protocol	Cat + Dog forms available. Introduces picking up items (F), environment interaction (E), and involuntary Dog morph. Three puzzle sections
Level 5 – Lumico	All three forms available after player realizes they can morph into a human. Front desk, lab, and office sections and a dual key card puzzle
Level 6 - The Shipment	All three forms are required in sequence. Cargo containers (cat), kitchen (human), sniff keycard (dog). After the crane sabotage, an ending triggers
Ending	Triggered when Sumi drops all containers into the ocean. Ending depends on the number of antidotes collected. The mid ending (two antidotes) can be triggered in any level after the first play through. And the true ending (all three antidotes) can be triggered in any level after the first playthrough.

Level 4 – Escape Protocol: Puzzle Designs

Level 4 introduces dog form and morphing mechanics. Guiding the player in the use of both forms to solve puzzles.

Section	Puzzles / Events	Forms Used	Key Mechanics
Cage Escape	Player swings left and right using the arrow keys. Reaching the left wall threshold breaks the cage and drops Sumi	Cat (default)	Intro to movement; no items yet.
Wire Room	Player presses E on the electrical panel. It tells player there is a small tear in the wire.	Cat	Intro to F (pickup) and E (interact). Wire visibly attached to door and clippers visibly on the floor.
Lab / Keycard	Player picks up a key card and carries it to the far right terminal. Presses E to scan it. Without the keycard, interacting with terminal with show dialogue. Door opens on success	Cat	Keycar + terminal interaction. Teaches inventory using and reminds the player of the one inventory slot.
Jump Scare/ Dog intro	Cutscene: Sumi is frightened and involuntarily transforms into a dog. Dialogue tells player about form switching using 1 + 2	Dog (forced)	First morph introduction. No player action required.
Scent trail / vent	In dog form players can see a scent trail. Following it reveals a vent cover. Press E as dog to open vent. Transform into cat to go through.	Dog + cat	Dogs can detect scent trails. Cats can fit through tight vents
Garbage Disposal	Garbage is too heavy for the cat. Shows a dialogue saying "it's too heavy for me..." Dog picks it up and disposes of by pressing E over the disposal. Shows a cutscene of guard being able to smell. A visual cue and a nudge towards using the dog to find the scent trail. The green overlay is also removed and clears up the level. Player can now go into control room as a cat when dog finds the vent and reveals it.	Dog + cat	Weight rule taught. Sequence: Dog garbage -> scent -> cat vent
Button Sequence	Two sticky notes hint at the solution "the direction of our brainstorm". Sequence displayed on the board. Player inputs 6 directional inputs, using the 4 directional buttons (left , right, up , and down). Green/red indicators for whether the sequence is correct and in that order. Once player enters the correct sequence, an animation plays, alarms sound, and the screen flashes red until the guard moves and comes to turn it off. The exit is now unguarded	Cat or dog form	L, D, R, R, U, L (normal playthrough sequence)

Level 5 – Lumico: Puzzle Designs

Level 5 introduces the Human form and is the most mechanically complex level. The layout is left-to-right but requires backtracking between rooms to collect items needed for later ones. Players must use all three forms across the rooms. The first scene introduces the human form by showing the player an animation about a 'Third Complete Form'.

Room	Contents	Forms Used	key Mechanics
Blue Area / Third Form Hint	Player walks right into a blue-lit area. An animation hints at a third form. Sumi shows a dialogue nudging at the possibility.	Cat/Dog	Narrative foreshadowing
Lockers / Reception / Bio Scanner	Lockers and reception are interactable with form specific dialogue. The bio-scanner is the gate. Human form is required, press E at the scanner as Human to open the door.	Human (required)	Teaches that certain interactives are human specific.
Office (PC Puzzle)	NPC warns about Kenji's deadline and says he misplaces things when panicking. Player interacts with the office PC as Human. An email interface loads, player must send the correct email to Kenji. "Meeting Notes."	Human	PC interaction is human-only. Email interface is a mini UI puzzle with user feedback
Printer Room / Kenji Manipulation	Player picks up crumpled paper that was from Kenji. (Animation of kenji throwing out paper). Enters the printer room with paper in inventory and presses E. Printer jams. Cutscene: Kenji is furious, drops a wrench on the printer and his ID near the trash bin while rushing.	Human	Indirect NPC manipulation. Item chain: Crumpled paper -> jam printer -> wrench + ID card
Lab / Tank B (Dr. Krieg)	Dr. Krieg (scientist) tells human form to log a replacement order for Tank B. It's cracking. Without a wrench or before trigger, player in human form interactions with the tank will say Dr. Krieg says to not touch it. With the wrench it triggers a cutscene: Tank B is smashed in, Dr. Krieg sets down the access card to deal with the mess and inspect the tank.	Human	Item used: wrench breaks tank. NPC reaction drops the second keycard.
Dual Access Card Module / Schedule	Upon interaction without ID it tells the player they need two access cards. The goal of the level. The schedule hints at the next level which is on the boat hence the boat schedule and player saying they need to catch the next shipment.	All forms upon interaction. Human form for ID insertion	Both keycards required to advanced to the next level.

Level 6 – The Shipment: Puzzle Designs

Level 6 is a mini heist. Sumi does not just escape. Sumi actively sabotages the Lumico cargo shipment on the way out. All three forms are required in sequence. The crane control room is the centrepiece mechanic and involves new programming logic. Different from the multi-step puzzles.

Room	Contents	Forms Used	Key Mechanics
Opening Cutscene	Camera zooms out revealing cargo containers and a ship with Lumico's logo. Player appears on the dock.	N/A.Cutscene	Establishes setting and stakes.
Dock Parkour & Guards	Player navigates over cargo containers and past four guards/workers. Guards have form-specific dialogue. Two pairs say	All forms	Environmental navigation. Dialogue-only guards (not enemies)

	different things. Passing the jumps leads to the boat section.		
Lockers	Player can interact with all lockers separately. Eventually finding the special locker that contains a chef hat. Pick up on F.	Any	Puzzle specific item
Chef/Kitchen Passage	Players must be in human form with chef hat in inventory to pass the chef. Any other forms will get knocked back regardless of inventory item.	Human + hat	Form + item gating. Chef says 'Ring the bell when food it ready. Don't get trigger happy'
Bell / Captain	Player rings the bell (E). Cutscene: Captain wakes upstairs and unlocks the bunker section. Then heads down to the kitchen	Any form can ring the bell	Scripted NPC interaction to unlock the next section.
Bunker / Scent Trail	Six beds total for 6 NPCs on boat. Dog form will reveal a scent trail to Captains bed. Pressing E in dog form will reveal the access card for the control room.	Dog	Only dog form can find the access card in the captain's bed. Any other forms won't be able to find the access card.
Control Room (Bookshelf) / Control panel	Access card in inventory opens the control room. In human form, player moves the bookshelf to reveal a safe (one of the secrets. See secrets section for solution). Further left player can interact with the control panel.	Human / all forms	Bookshelf is human only. Control panel is all forms
Crane Mini-game	New scene: four buttons (left, right, lower, release) and 5 cargo boxes. Sumi is in cat form, not morphing allowed/needed. Players guides Sumi to interact with the buttons to visually see the crane moving on screen. Goal is to move the crane onto one of the boxes (Crane auto-grabs the boxes when in contact) then to move the boxes to either side to drop it all in the ocean.	Cat	New crane control mechanic. All 5 boxes must be dropped to trigger the ending on the first run

Rules and Victory Conditions

- The goal of the first DLC playthrough is to complete all three levels (4, 5, 6) and reach the ending.
- In subsequence playthroughs, the goal is to find and collect all three antidote pieces hidden across the levels.
- Collecting 0 or 1 antidote pieces trigger the Bad Ending.
- Collecting exactly 2 antidote pieces triggers the Mid Ending
- Collecting all three antidote pieces triggers the Good/True Ending.
- The Good Ending is also obtainable on the first playthrough. It rewards curios and experimental players.

Endings

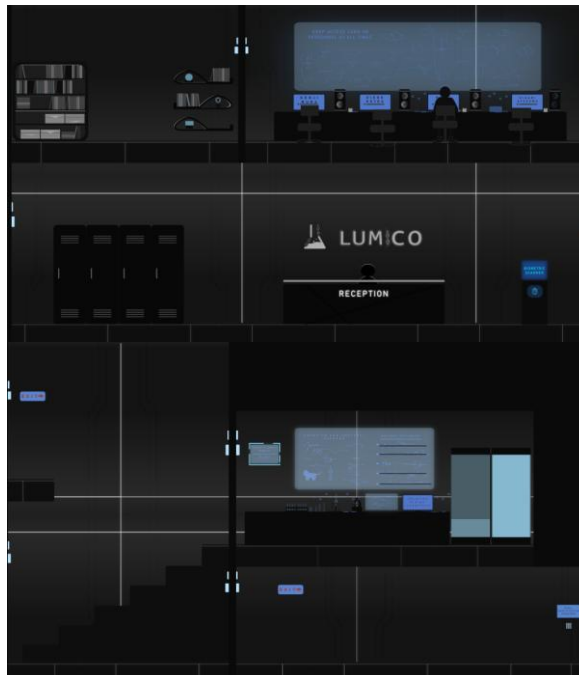
A3 introduces three distinct endings. Standard, Good/True, and a third ending (Mid Ending) which ensures that partial progress is still rewarded rather than tied to a binary outcome.

Ending	Trigger	What Happens
Bad Ending	0 – 1 antidote pieces collected	Sumi boards the boat but the serum's effects accelerate. The transformations become uncontrollable. Sumi arrives near home but cannot approach. The owner is shown at the gate calling out. Sumi watches from a distance. A replay hook appears: 'Sumi never learned the full truth. Maybe something was left behind in the facility.'
Mid Ending	2 antidote pieces collected	Sumi makes it home but cannot fully control the morphing. Some days cat, some days something in between. The ending hints that Sumi can only stay for so long. Encourages a third playthrough to find the final piece.
Good / True Ending	All 3 antidote pieces are collected	Sumi makes it home and stays for good this time, Sumi can finally be reunited with their owner. A full circle back to A2 beginning.

Game World

A3 takes place entirely within the Lumico corporate complex and Lumico's boat. A deliberately confined space, contrast to A2's open outdoor environment shift. The visual tone is significantly darker and more serious than A2, reflecting the tonal shift from adventure to escape.

Level	Title	Description & Atmosphere
4	Chapter 4 Escape Protocol	Sterile, fluorescent-lit lab sections. Sumi wakes up in a cage. Tense and claustrophobic. The sound track is more about ambience and reflects the shift to a more serious tone. 
5	Chapter 5 Lumico	Sleek corporate HQ. Lab and office sections. Busy area. The soundtrack is office ambience and mimics a work place. Environment feels sterile, dark, cool toned, and serious.

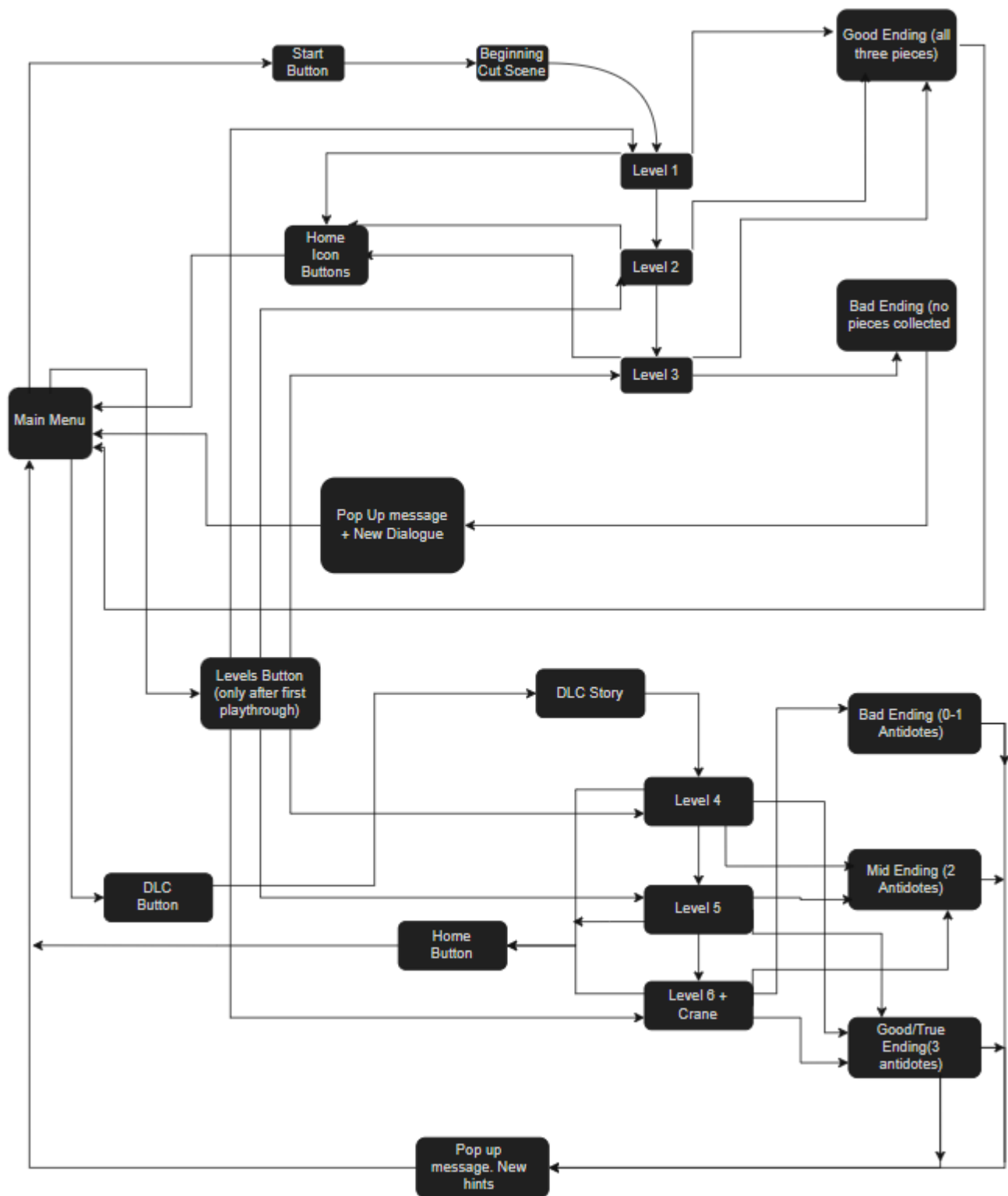


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Chapter 6 The Shipment

Dark industrial port at night in the opening scene. Shipping containers, cranes, and ocean. The level takes places on a Lumico boat. Soundtrack is ocean and boat ambience. Ocean waves, and rain.





Secrets / Replay Incentives & New Game+

Secrets & Antidote Pieces

There are three hidden antidote pieces. One per level. All secrets are harder than A2's recipe pieces, however with the new hint system, players will always be able to find it. All the secrets require awareness of surroundings and deliberate use of morph forms. That prevents discoverability risk. The hint system escalates from subtle to explicit across 5 hints per level.

Antidote Piece	Level	How to Find It
Antidote 1	4 Escape Protocol	At the button panel, enter the mirrored version of the main sequence: R, U, L, L, D, R (original was (L ,D, R, R, U, L). A hidden box opens and the antidote appears. The garbage disposal puzzle must be completed first or the sequence panel is inaccessible. Prevents sequence abuse.
Antidote 2	5 Lumico	In the lab, the scientist's notes contain on legible ingredient: 'mouse'. A quiet squeak can be heard near Tank B. Cat form can enter the far-right vent and climb into the L-shaped upper section. The squeak grows louder. Players find a mouse and picks it up and brings it to the scientist. It jumps onto the scientist and he drops the antidote as the mouse runs away.
Antidote 3	6 The Shipment	In the control room, Human form moves the bookshelf to reveal a safe. The safe riddle (on the safe door) reads: "First impressions only. Letters and then numbers. Start low, always left to right. End at the anchor." The main hint is the anchor. The only colorful piece in the entire level is the anchor on the captains bunkers. So that means the hint is in the bunkers. First impressions mean first letter/numbers. Letters and then numbers, type in all letters and then type in all numbers. Start low, always left to right. Start on the low bunkers, read from left to right. End at the anchor, the last digit is on the captain's name plate. The pass code is: LSK249. Opening the safe will reveal the last antidote.

New Game+ / Replay Incentives

- After the first DLC playthrough ends in the bad ending, a popup explains antidote collection and grants access to individual DLC levels as well as the original levels to collect those secrets and the other endings as well.
- Secret antidote HUD counter is visible from the start of all subsequent playthroughs.
- It'll show a Lumico logo on the levels where the antidote has been collected.
- Hint system shifts focus in subsequent playthroughs. Hints in the first playthrough will guide player through each level. In subsequent playthroughs it'll guide the player to obtaining the antidotes. With hints becoming more obvious as player goes down the list.

- With the three new obtainable endings, replayability is not tied to just one completionist goal (obtaining all three secrets, A2). The branching NPC dialogue per form and per item, also provide players with more to explore in each level.
- All three endings in the DLC are obtainable on the first play through. Rewarding thoroughness at any stage.
- Main menu background once again changes after the DLC playthrough, reflecting the current game state.
- Over all replayability is supported through branching form-specific dialogue, multiple endings at different collection thresholds, and a hint system that changes focus between playthroughs, ensuring each run offers a meaningfully different experience

Extras & Polish

- Every interactable object has form-specific dialogue. Each form has a distinct personality that carries across all three levels. And different NPCs all say different things to the player depending on their form
- Extensive sound design: door opens, dialogue popups, text popups, button presses, correct/wrong sounds, mouse squeaks, crane sounds, environmental ambience, alarms.
- Players can still meow/bark, but it's just for extras and allow players to have more interactions with the game world throughout each level.
- Guards against physics abuse and sequence skipping are built into puzzle triggers (e.g garbage must be disposed before button panel activates).
- No fall damage, no lives, removes frustration while keeping tension and makes the player really think about their next move and what the environment shows.
- Level design philosophy: Level 4 teaches Dog and Cat forms, using both forms to gain access/solve puzzles. Level 5 teaches about the third form, human form and teaches the player some items are only interactable in human forms. Level 6 requires all three forms in sequence.
- Three endings ensure all players feel rewarded regardless of how many antidotes they find.
- The hint system eliminates any discoverability risk and frustrate the player if the puzzles are too difficult but they still want different endings.

Artwork & Attribution

All sprites, character designs, backgrounds, animations, and any visual assets in Sumi's Journey were hand-drawn from scratch by the author/developer using Inkscape. Visual references were used solely for inspiration during the design process. All final artwork represents original creative work by the author.

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